# From Review to Remediation: Building a Sustainable Reparative Metadata Workflow



LIBRARIES


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NLA + MPLA Joint Conference
La Vista, NE
October 15, 2026

# Pilot

**April 2025 to August 2026**

Library of Congress Subject Headings:

- Illegal immigration
- Problem children
- Sexual minorities
- McKinley, Mount (Alaska)
- America, Gulf of

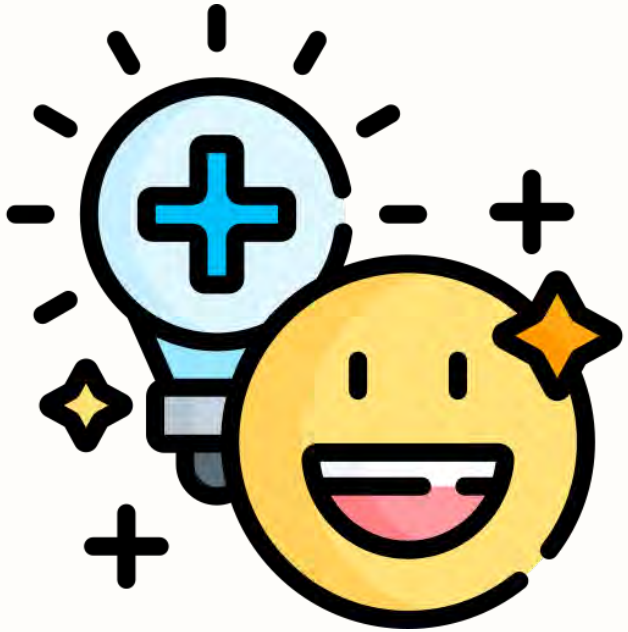


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# Goal

**Develop practices to replace or supplement pejorative or outdated terms in our metadata**

Engage stakeholders early and often
Build sustainable, documented processes
Leverage native Alma and Primo tools
Apply changes consortium-wide
Design every change to be reversible



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# Getting started

## Other library work as inspiration

University of Toronto:
Indigenous Metadata Work

Washington Research Library Consortium:
Reparative Cataloging CoP



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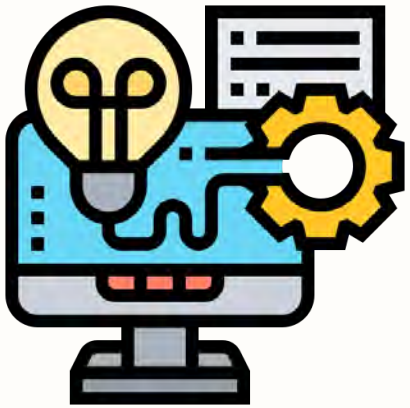
# Research

## Ask...

What do people call themselves?
What's respectful?
What's current?
What do other libraries use?
Who should we ask?
Replace, supplement, or keep?

## Find...

Testimonials
Affinity groups
Committee publications
Peer libraries
News and journal articles



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# Recommend

## Identify action to propose

- Replace
- Conditional
- Supplement
- Retain



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# Rationale examples 1 & 2

Although these terms refer to the broad group of people who enter or remain in a country without legal authorization, the use of "Illegal," "unauthorized," and "undocumented" imply different connotations and perspectives. Not all immigration starts out as illegal activity. UNL Libraries considers "Undocumented immigration" a more respectful and neutral term to use.

The Library of Congress decided to replace the pejorative "Illegal aliens" heading with a complex solution, two tandem headings, "Noncitizens" and "Illegal immigration." When the immigration heading is present on records with headings containing "Noncitizens" (or many related variations), UNL Libraries will change the heading to use "Undocumented immigrants" instead.

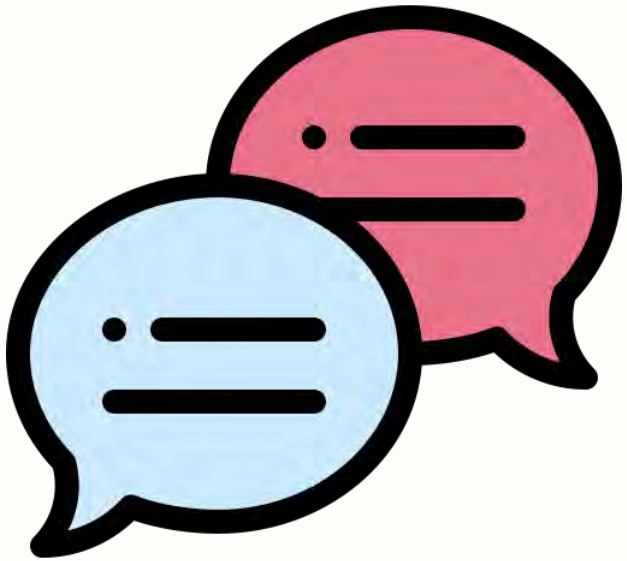
# Rationale example 3

Library of Congress and the US Geological Survey (USGS) changed this term due to the signing of Executive Order 14172. As a US institution, it serves our users for our records to be consistent with the geographic names used by government agencies. However, there is an opportunity for confusion and a chance that resources become less discoverable for users who are unaware of the name change or its impact to LCSH. There has also been tension in both public and library discourse surrounding the reasons for the name change and the cultural impacts of the change. UNL Libraries will supplement records with both names.

# Stakeholders

## We asked before we changed

Shared every proposal before implementation
Engaged Libraries staff, groups, and consortium members
Consulted communities and subject experts
Adapted when feedback called for it

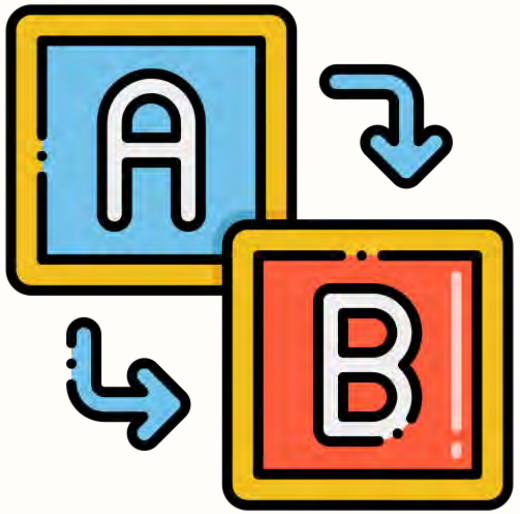


Speech Bubble free icon created by Magnific - Flaticon

# Making the change

**At this point:**

- ✓ Identified term needing reparative work
- ✓ Chose replacement/supplemental term
- ✓ Determined an action (replace, supplement, etc.)
- ✓ Gathered feedback from stakeholders




**Choose the technical approach that best suits the desired action. Every approach is easily reversible!**

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# Local Authority Records

**A quick and simple way to make direct 1:1 changes**

- Derived from existing LCSH records
- Added field to include rationale for the change
- Alma's Preferred Term Correction job automatically changes the subject headings
- Used for Illegal immigration, Sexual minorities, and Problem children

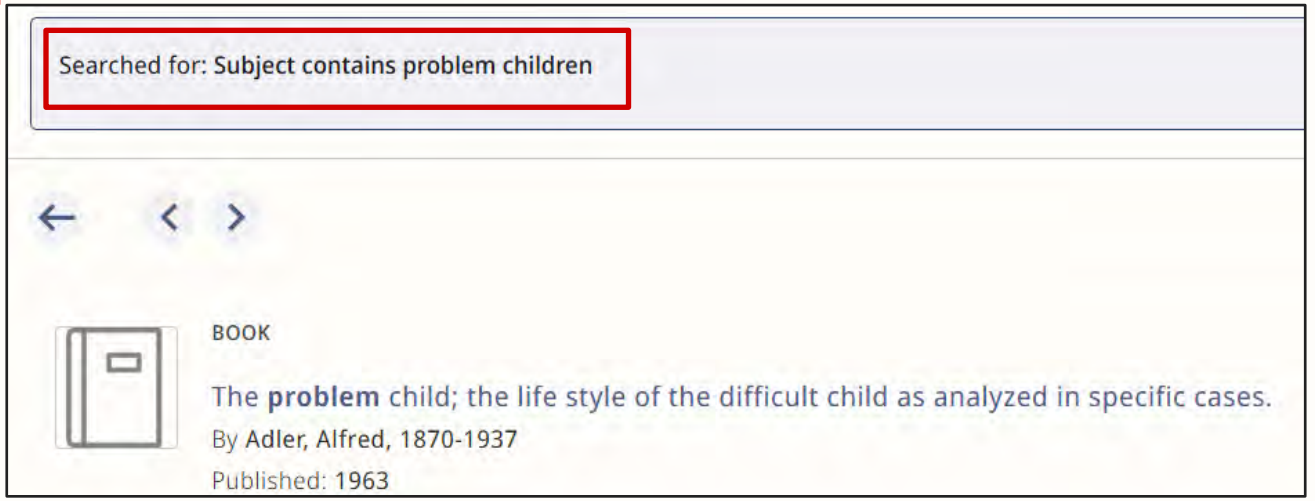


Authority free icon created by Flat Icons - Flaticon

| | |
|---|---|
| **010** | __ \|a sh 85107104 |
| **035** | __ \|a (DLC) sh 85107104 |
| **035** | __ \|a (LIBRARY_OF_CONGRESS)981709199000000041 |
| **040** | __ \|a DLC \|c DLC \|d DLC \|d ViU |
| **150** | __ \|a Children with behavioral problems |
| **450** | __ \|a Problem children \|5 NbU |
| **450** | __ \|a Difficult children |
| **450** | __ \|a Maladjusted children |
| **550** | __ \|w g \|a Children |
| **550** | __ \|a Behavior disorders in children |
| **667** | __ \|a "Problem children" is a term that was used in educational and psychological literature to describe children with behavior issues due to emotional instability or social environment. The literature has shifted to focus on the behavior rather than the nature of the children, making this term outdated. Current headings found in relevant databases include "behavior problems" and "problem behavior." UNL Libraries considers "Children with behavioral problems" to be a more respectful and neutral term and that it maintains parity with the terminology currently found in the relevant psychological and educational literature databases. |
| **670** | __ \|a Difficult children, there is no such thing, c2003: \|b t.p. introd. (children demonstrating behavioral disorders are being classified as educationally difficult to manage) |
| **680** | __ \|i Here are entered works on children with behavior difficulties due to emotional instability or social environment. |

## Details

| | |
|---|---|
| Title | The **problem** child; the life style of the difficult child as analyzed in specific cases. |
| Creator | Adler, Alfred, 1870-1937 |
| Publisher | New York Capricorn Books |
| Creation Date | 1963 |
| Format | xvii, 172 p. 21 cm |
| Note | "The present volume was published in German in 1930, as one of the volumes on Die Technik der Individualpsychologie ... and bore the subtitle Die Seele des schwererziehbaren Schulkindes." |
| Subject | **Children with behavioral problems** |
| Series | A Capricorn giant original, 228 |
| Source | Library Catalog |




https://unl.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01UON_LINC/4occt9/alma991017618739706387

# Normalization Rules

**Some LCSH have multiple meanings or contexts that make a direct one-to-one change unsuitable.**

- Normalization rules can change context-specific subject headings
- Used for the subject headings "Noncitizens" only when it appeared in records alongside "Illegal immigration"
- Rule is applied quarterly to catch newly added records

```
rule "Change 650.a Noncitizens to 650.a Undocumented immigrants when appearing with 650.a Illegal immigration"
when
   (exists "650.a.Noncitizens*") and (exists "650.a.Undocumented immigration*|Illegal immigration*")
then
   replaceContents "650.a.Noncitizens" with "Undocumented immigrants"
end
```

## Details

| | |
|---|---|
| Title | Alien smuggling : management and operational improvements needed to address growing problem : report to congressional committees |
| Creator | United States. General Accounting Office |
| Publisher | Washington, D.C. P.O. Box 37050, Washington, D.C. 20013 : The Office |
| Creation Date | 2000 |
| Format | 35 p. : ill. ; 28 cm |
| Note | Cover title<br>"May 2000."<br>"GAO/GGD-00-103."<br>"B-283952"--P. 1 |
| Subject | **Undocumented immigrants** -- Government policy -- United States<br>Smuggling -- United States -- Prevention<br>**Undocumented immigration** -- Government policy -- United States<br>**Undocumented immigrants** |
| Genre | Electronic books |
| Source | Library Catalog |

https://unl.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01UON_LINC/4occt9/alma991005416739706387

# Normalization Rules

**In some cases, we deemed it appropriate to supplement LCSH rather than replace them.**

- Normalization rules added our supplemental headings in records that had specific LCSH
- This approach was used for the LCSH "America, Gulf of" and "McKinley, Mount (Alaska)" to support discoverability
- Added subject term in a local subject field (690)

```
rule "Add 690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska), Gulf of when 651.a.McKinley, Mount (Alaska)*"
when
   (exists "651.a.McKinley, Mount (Alaska)*")
then
   addField "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)" if (not exists "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)*")
   addSubfield "690.5.NbU" if (exists "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)")
   addSubfield "690.9.local" if (exists "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)")
   correctDuplicateSubfields "690" "59"
   correctDuplicateFields "690"
```

## Details

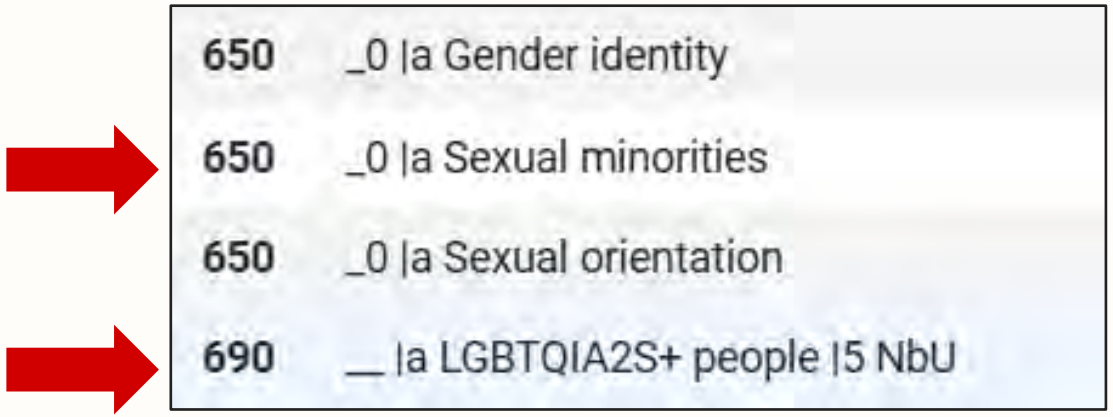
| | |
|---|---|
| Title | **The ascent of Denali (Mount McKinley)** : a narrative of the first complete **ascent** of the highest peak in North America |
| Creator | Stuck, Hudson, 1863-1920 |
| Publisher | Lincoln : University of Nebraska Press |
| Creation Date | 1989 |
| Format | xix, 188 p., 34 leaves of plates : ill., maps ; 21 cm |
| Note | Reprint. Originally published: New York : Scribner, 1914<br>"A Bison book." |
| Subject | Stuck, Hudson, 1863-1920 -- Travel -- Alaska -- **McKinley, Mount**<br>Mountaineering -- Alaska -- **McKinley, Mount**<br>**McKinley, Mount** (Alaska)<br>Denali, **Mount** (Alaska) |
| Source | Library Catalog |

https://unl.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01UON_LINC/4occt9/alma991011224519706387

# Challenges: Community Zone (CZ)

**We are unable to change existing metadata in records sourced from the Alma CZ**

- Normalization rules can supplement CZ records with preferred subject headings
- Subjects are added in a local subject field (690)
- LCSH are hidden from display using DEI exclude list in instances of direct 1:1 changes




## Details

| | |
|---|---|
| Title | **Gender Is Really Strange.** |
| Creator | Goetz, Teddy G., author. |
| Contributor | Standing, Sophie, illustrator. |
| Publisher | London : Jessica Kingsley Publishers |
| Creation Date | 2023 |
| Format | 1 online resource (42 pages)<br>text file rdaft |
| Subject | **Gender** identity<br>Sexual orientation<br>LGBTQIA2S+ people |

# Challenges: CDI Records

**The only tool capable of impacting Central Discovery Index (CDI) records is Alma's DEI exclude list**

- The DEI exclude list can remove and replace subject terms and add annotations to subjects in display
- It is limited in function and is only useful for direct 1:1 changes in CDI records
- Using it will apply to all records, not just CDI

# Results

| LCSH | Repaired subject heading |
| --- | --- |
| ~~Illegal immigration~~ | Undocumented immigration |
| ~~Problem children~~ | Children with behavioral problems |
| ~~Sexual minorities~~ | LGBTQIA2S+ people |
| McKinley, Mount (Alaska) | Denali, Mount (Alaska) |
| America, Gulf of | Mexico, Gulf of |

# Next Steps & Resources

**Although the pilot project has finished, the work continues.**

- A new group will convene to continue identifying problematic and replacement subject headings
- We are developing a submission form for users to let us know if they find a subject heading in need of reparative work
- We are maintaining a GitHub repository containing our normalization rules and workflows

# Resources


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Hostage, John. "Updating Place Names in the Name Authority File to Reflect Political Realities: The Cases of Crimea, Taiwan, and Myanmar." *Cataloging & Classification Quarterly* 57, no. 6 (2019): 407–22. https://doi.org/10.1080/01639374.2019.1658676.

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Perera, Treshani. "Ethical Description: Local Solutions." Paper presented at the Music Library Association 2023 Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO, March 3, 2023. https://works.hcommons.org/records/zzpqc-xnd07.

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# Thank you!



https://go.unl.edu/acme-presentations

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